

DIGITAL DIGNITY

A Compassion Activity to Bridge the Digital Divide for Older Adults

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Course / Subject: MOAM(MASTERY OVER MIND)

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1. INTRODUCTION

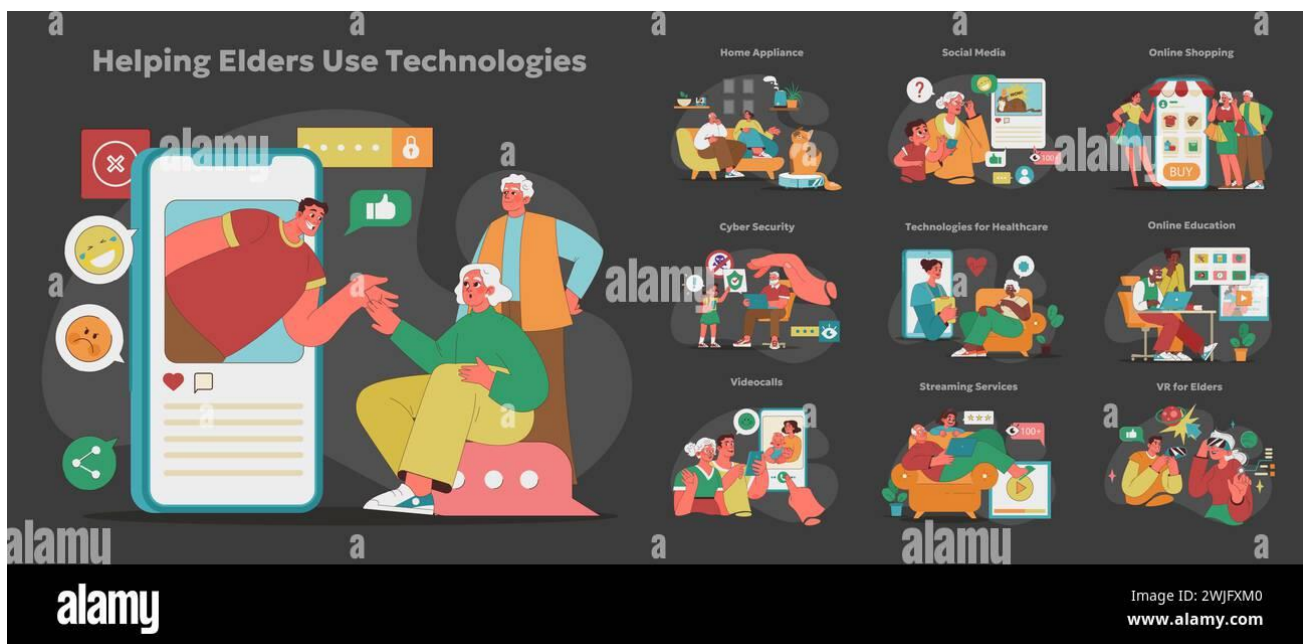
Digital technology has become part of everyday life. People use smartphones to communicate, access public services, find directions, manage appointments and obtain information. However, many older adults may not have had the same opportunities to learn these tools. Small screens, unfamiliar menus, fear of making mistakes and online scams can make technology stressful. Digital Dignity is a compassion activity designed to help older adults build useful digital skills with patience, respect and confidence.



2. AIM AND OBJECTIVES

Aim: To reduce the everyday digital barriers experienced by older adults while protecting their independence, privacy and dignity.

- Understand the learner's own needs instead of assuming what they cannot do.
- Teach practical smartphone skills in simple, manageable steps.
- Encourage the learner to practise independently rather than having a volunteer do everything.
- Introduce safe digital habits, especially around suspicious links, passwords, PINs and OTPs.
- Build confidence and reduce the fear of asking questions or making mistakes.



3. WHAT IS DIGITAL DIGNITY?

Digital dignity means helping someone access technology without making them feel incapable, dependent or embarrassed. It combines digital inclusion with respect, consent and privacy. The learner remains in control of their own device and chooses what they want to learn. The volunteer acts as a guide, not as someone who takes control.



4. ACTIVITY PLAN

Step 1 — Ask and listen

Begin with a respectful conversation. Ask which phone task the person would most like to learn and what they already know.

Step 2 — Choose two or three goals

For example, saving a contact, making a video call, increasing text size, using voice typing or identifying a suspicious message.

Step 3 — Demonstrate one step at a time

Use plain language, a comfortable pace and short instructions. Avoid technical jargon.

Step 4 — Let the learner practise

Invite the person to repeat the steps on their own phone. Offer hints instead of immediately taking the device.

Step 5 — Repeat and encourage

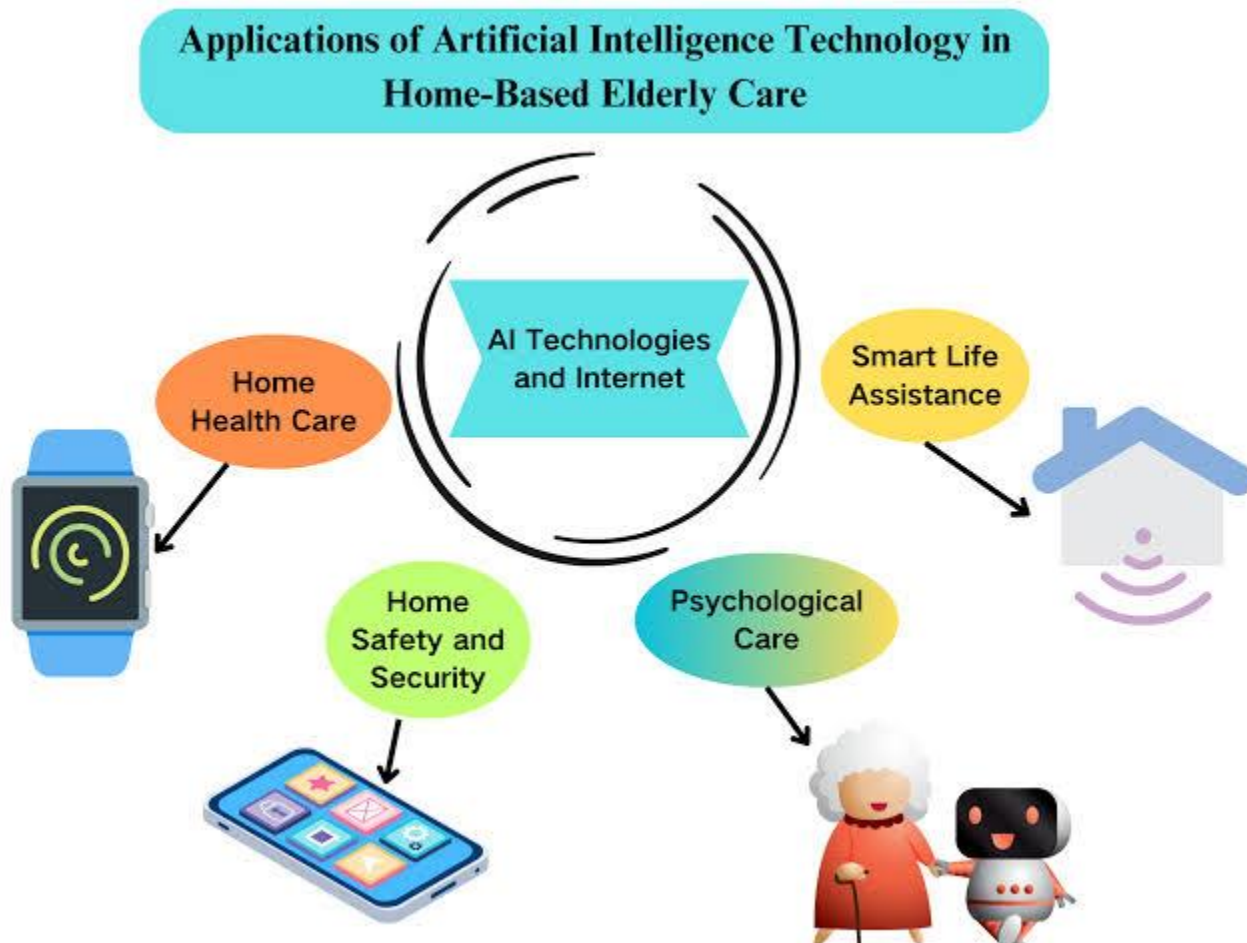
Allow time for repetition. Treat mistakes as a normal part of learning and praise effort rather than speed.

Step 6 — Review together

Ask the learner to demonstrate the task once more and choose a skill they would like to practise next.

5. SKILLS WE CAN TEACH

- **Communication:** Saving a contact, making a call, sending a voice message or joining a video call.
- **Accessibility:** Increasing text size, adjusting brightness, enabling captions or trying voice typing.
- **Everyday digital tasks:** Using maps, finding reliable information or understanding appointment reminders.
- **Digital safety:** Recognising suspicious links, checking who sent a message and protecting passwords, PINs and OTPs.



6. ETHICS, PRIVACY AND SAFETY

- Ask permission before assisting or touching the person's phone.
- Never ask for, record or share passwords, PINs, OTPs or banking details.
- Avoid using banking, payment or other sensitive apps as practice activities.
- Do not browse personal messages, photographs or files without explicit permission.
- Do not pressure the learner; respect their pace and their right to stop.
- Take or share photographs and videos only with clear permission.
- Encourage the learner to pause and verify suspicious messages rather than clicking immediately.

STRAND 1 • TEACH DIGCIT

DIGITAL SAFETY

Digital citizens keep themselves and each other safe.

Icons surrounding the central shield: People, Laptop, Globe, Wi-Fi, Cloud, Smartphone.

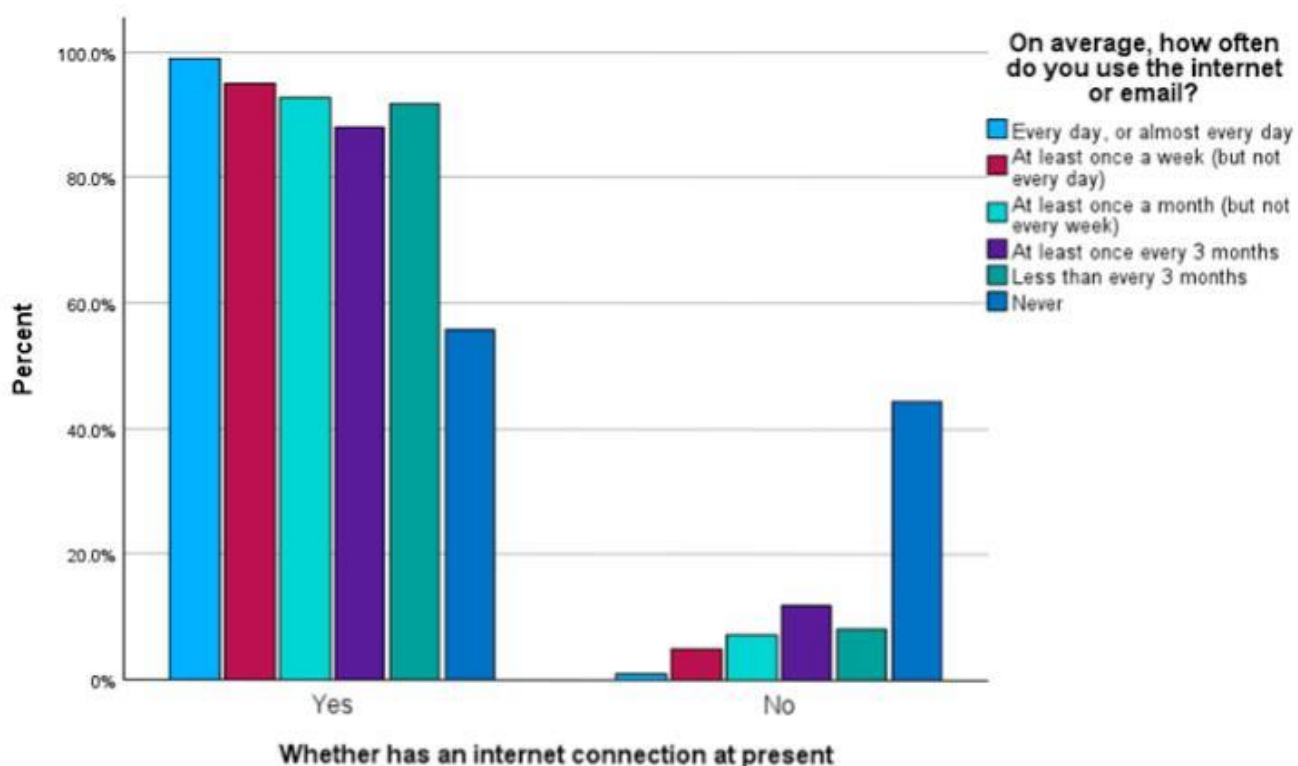
- Navigating rules, policies, laws & digital boundaries
- Understanding privacy, data commodification & digital footprints
- Recognizing risks of online fraud, exploitation & deception

Explore Strand 1 at TeachDigCit.com/framework

7. MEASURING THE IMPACT

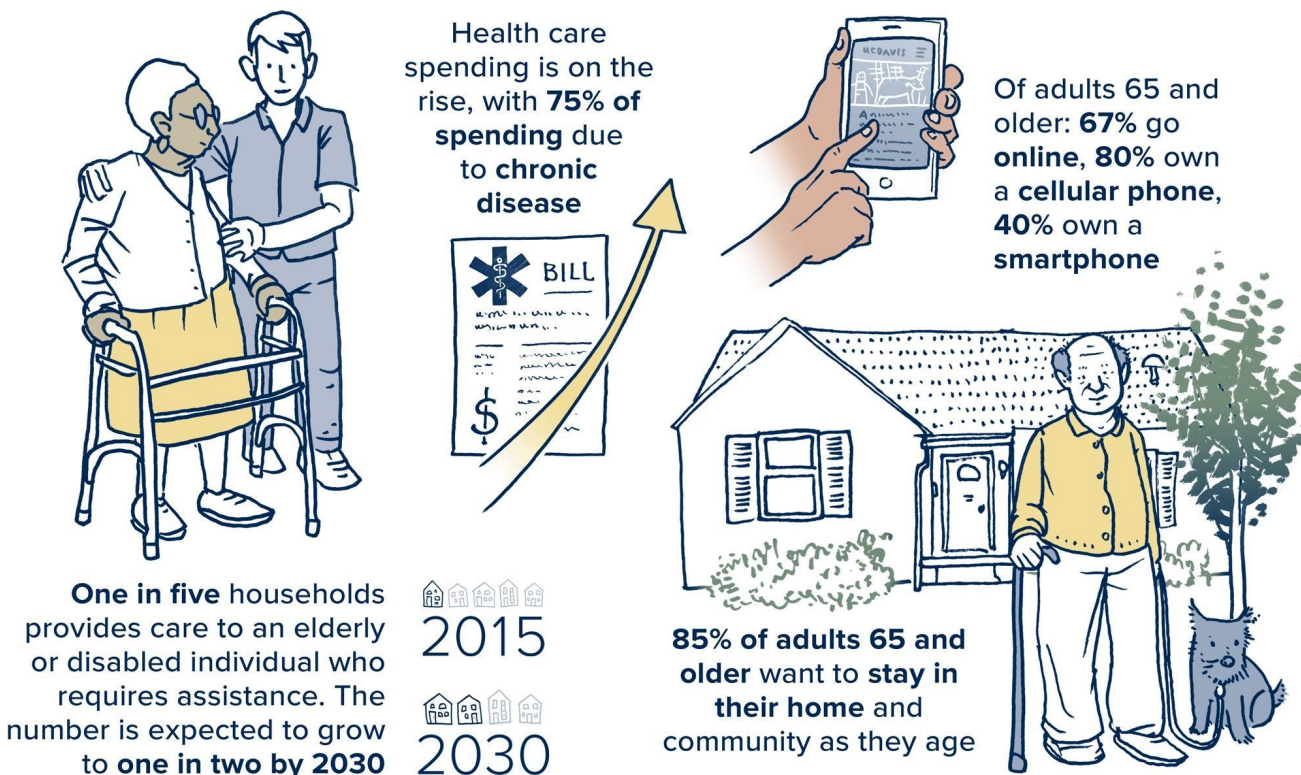
The impact can be assessed by comparing the learner's confidence before and after the session. At the beginning, ask which tasks feel difficult and how confident they feel. At the end, ask them to demonstrate the selected task without the volunteer taking over. Record only general learning outcomes, not personal or sensitive information.

- Can the learner complete at least one selected task with less assistance?
- Can the learner explain one basic digital-safety rule?
- Does the learner report feeling more confident or less hesitant?
- Has the learner identified a next skill they would like to learn?



8. EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Improved confidence in using selected smartphone features.
- Greater independence in completing everyday digital tasks.
- Better awareness of common digital risks.
- A more respectful and inclusive relationship between generations.
- A reminder that meaningful compassion often means teaching a skill rather than doing a task for someone.



9. SAMPLE REFLECTION

This activity shows that the digital divide is not only about access to devices; it can also be about confidence, opportunity and patient guidance. By listening first and teaching without judgement, we can help older adults feel more included in a digital world. The most important result is not how many buttons we teach them to press, but whether they feel respected and more able to act independently.

OID AGE ROOMS

WhatsApp Facebook Instagram YouTube LinkedIn

Senior Citizens & Digital literacy: bridging the gap

Digital Literacy

- Functional skills
- Creativity
- Critical thinking and evaluation
- Cultural and social understanding
- Collaboration
- The ability to find and select information
- Effective communication
- E-safety

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10. SHORT PRESENTATION SCRIPT

Good morning. Our compassion activity is called Digital Dignity. We chose this topic because many everyday services now depend on smartphones, yet some older adults may feel uncertain about using them. Our aim is not to take their phones and complete tasks for them. Instead, we ask what they want to learn, demonstrate each step patiently and let them practise independently. We can teach useful skills such as saving contacts, making video calls, adjusting text size and recognising suspicious messages. We also protect their privacy by never asking for passwords, PINs or OTPs. We will measure success through confidence, safe habits and the ability to repeat a task with less help. Digital dignity reminds us that compassion is helping someone become more independent while preserving their respect. Thank you



11. SIMPLE SESSION CHECKLIST

- ☐ We asked the learner what they wanted to learn.
- ☐ We agreed on two or three achievable goals.
- ☐ We explained one step at a time.
- ☐ The learner practised using their own device.
- ☐ We respected privacy and did not collect sensitive details.
- ☐ We reviewed progress and asked what they want to learn next.

Thank You



Together, let's build a world where everyone feels included, connected and valued — digitally.



More
Connection



More
Opportunities



More
Inclusion



A Brighter
Future

